Minimalist Beamer Theme

User manual and example gallery

Version 1.1.0

pdfLaTeX • XeLaTeX • LuaLaTeX

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Getting started

What is this theme?

A **minimalist** Beamer theme: white background, **blue tones**, sans-serif text, no navigation symbols, and a small set of reusable building blocks.

Layout

- Left-aligned title page and frame titles
- Optional section divider pages
- `onecol`, `twocol` and `threecol` environments

Content

- Figures: TikZ, `\flow`, images
- Tables: `booktabs`, `L/C/R`
- Boxes: `callout`, `warnbox`, ...
- Code listings and math

> Documentation and commands are in English; your slides can be in any `babel` language (e.g. Spanish: ñ, á, ¿, ¡).

Quick start

```
\documentclass[11pt,aspectratio=169]{beamer}
\usepackage[spanish,es-tabla]{babel}   % or english, etc.
\usetheme[footer=total]{minimalist}

\title{My talk}
\author{Me}
\begin{document}
\frame{\titlepage}
\frame{\frametitle{Hello}
  Some text and a \concept{key term}.}
\end{document}
```

Put `beamerthememinimalist.sty` next to your `.tex` file (or in your local `texmf` tree) and compile with `latexmk -pdf`.

Theme options

Pass options to the theme: `\usetheme[options]{minimalist}`.

Option	Values	Default	Effect
`palette`	`blue`, `teal`, `indigo`, `green`, `graphite`	`blue`	Color preset (accent + warm alert color)
`accent`	any color expr.	from palette	Overrides the main color; all tints follow it
`footer`	`number`, `total`, `none`	`number`	Frame counter style (bottom right)
`font`	`helvetica`, `default`	`helvetica`	Helvetica clone, or Beamer's default sans font
`titlerule`	boolean	`false`	Thin rule under each frame title
`sectionpages`	boolean	`false`	Automatic divider frame at each `\section`

Example: `\usetheme[palette=teal,footer=total,titlerule]{minimalist}`

Palettes and color psychology

Palette	Colors	Typical association and use
`blue` (default)		Trust, calm, focus. Safe choice for lectures and technical talks
`teal`		Clarity and balance; fresh, modern, good for learning content
`indigo`		Depth and seriousness; research and formal presentations
`green`		Growth and ease; comfortable for long reading
`graphite`		The original neutral gray look

How color is used

- **Cool accent** (wide bar): titles, bullets, rules, box frames.
- **Very light tint**: block and note backgrounds.
- **Warm alert** (narrow bar): **use once per slide** to pull the eye, as it contrasts with blue.

Keep in mind

Color associations vary by culture and context; they are tendencies, not rules. Legibility matters most: every preset keeps text and accent at $\geq$ 4.5:1 contrast on white.

Languages and TeX engines

Languages

- The theme never loads `babel`: you choose the language.
- Captions follow `babel`: *Figure*, *Figura*, *Tabla*.
- With Spanish, `es-tabla` gives “Tabla” instead of “Cuadro”.
- Accents and `ñ ¿ ¡` work out of the box (UTF-8).

Engines

- **pdfLaTeX**: T1 fonts and the Helvetica clone.
- **XeLaTeX** / **LuaLaTeX**: `fontspec` with TeX Gyre Heros.
- Detection is automatic (`iftex`).
- Listings accept accented characters under all engines.

```
\usepackage[spanish,es-tabla]{babel}  % load BEFORE \usetheme
\usetheme{minimalist}
```

Page layout

Title page and sections

The `\titlepage` shows title, subtitle, author, institute and date, left aligned with a short accent rule.

- `\section{...}` marks a section; with the option `sectionpages` a divider frame is inserted automatically.
- Without that option, insert one manually: `\begin{frame}\sectionpage\end{frame}`.
- `\tableofcontents` uses numbered sections.
- `\framesubtitle{...}` adds a subtitle under the frame title.

One column

By default content uses the full text width, which is **one column**. For a narrower, centered measure use `onecol`:

```
\begin{onecol}[width=0.7]
  A narrower text block, centered
  on the slide. Good for quotes,
  definitions or short statements.
\end{onecol}
```

A narrower text block, centered on the slide. Good for quotes, definitions or short statements.

`width` is a fraction of the text width (default `0.8`).

Two columns: result

Use `twocol` on the slides that need it

Left column

- Plain text, lists, formulas…
- Any content works inside a column.

Right column

Boxes, figures and tables fit too.

Content after `\end{twocol}` goes back to the full width.

Two or three columns: source and keys

```
\begin{twocol}[split=0.45]
  Left column content
\nextcol
  Right column content
\end{twocol}
% three columns: \begin{threecol} A \nextcol B \nextcol C \end{threecol}
```

Key	Default	Meaning
`split`	`0.5`	Left column share of the width (`twocol` only)
`gap`	`0.04` / `0.06`*	Fraction of the width left empty between columns
`align`	`T`	Vertical alignment: `T`, `c` or `b`

* default for `twocol` / `threecol`.

Building blocks

Text helpers

```
\concept{Key term} in bold,
\code{inline\_code()} in monospace,
\alert{alert} for emphasis.

\flowline{Design, Code, Test, Integrate}

Single arrow: A \arr\ B
```

Key term in bold,
`inline_code()` in monospace,
alert for emphasis.
Design → **Code** → **Test** → **Integrate**
Single arrow: A → B

Standard `itemize`, `enumerate` and `description` keep Beamer's behavior, tinted with the accent color.

Figures: process flows with `\flow`

`\flow{A, B, C}` draws a centered chain of nodes joined by arrows and shrinks it to fit the line. Use `\\` for line breaks.

```
\flow{Requirements, Domain\\model, Design, Code}
```

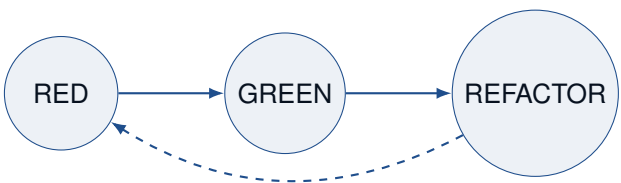


Pass TikZ options in brackets: `\flow[node distance=1cm]{...}`.

Figures: custom TikZ with theme styles

Styles: `mn node`, `mn arrow`, `mn dashed arrow`, `mn circle`.

```
\begin{tikzpicture}[mn circle/.append style={minimum size=1.5cm}]
  \node[mn circle] (r) {RED};
  \node[mn circle, right=1.4cm of r] (g) {GREEN};
  \node[mn circle, right=1.4cm of g] (f) {REFACTOR};
  \draw[mn arrow] (r) -- (g);  \draw[mn arrow] (g) -- (f);
  \draw[mn dashed arrow, bend left=30] (f) to (r);
\end{tikzpicture}
```



Figures: images and captions

```
\begin{figure}
  \centering
  \includegraphics[width=0.6\linewidth]
    %
    {example-image-a}
  \caption{An example image.}
\end{figure}
```

Captions are numbered and follow the `babel` language.

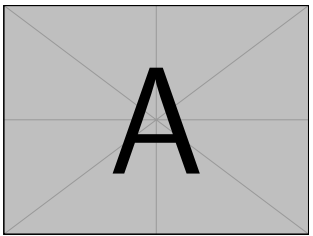


Figure 1: An example image.

Tables

Use `booktabs` rules and the column types `L{w}`, `C{w}`, `R{w}` (left, centered, right; fixed width, wrapped text).

```
\begin{table}
  \centering
  \begin{tabular}{@{}L{1.7cm}C{1cm}R{1.1cm}@{}}
    \toprule
    \textbf{Item} & \textbf{Qty} & \textbf{Price}\\
    \midrule
    Pencil & 3 & 1.20\\
    Notebook & 2 & 4.50\\
    \bottomrule
  \end{tabular}
  \caption{A table.}
\end{table}
```

Item	Qty	Price
Pencil	3	1.20
Notebook	2	4.50

Table 1: A table.

Boxes: `callout` and `statement`

```
\begin{callout}
  Outlined box for a key idea.
\end{callout}

\begin{callout}[title=With a title]
  Any tcolorbox key can be passed.
\end{callout}

\begin{statement}
  A centered, emphasized sentence.
\end{statement}
```

Outlined box for a key idea.

With a title

Any tcolorbox key can be passed.

A centered, emphasized sentence.

Boxes: `notebox` and `warnbox`

```
\begin{notebox}[title=Note]
  Soft tinted note with a bar.
\end{notebox}

\begin{warnbox}[title=Attention]
  Warm color: use sparingly.
\end{warnbox}
```

Note

Soft tinted note with a bar.

Attention

Warm color: use sparingly.

Both accept the same keys as `callout` (`title`, `halign`, ...).

Beamer blocks

```
\begin{block}{Block}
  Standard Beamer block.
\end{block}
\begin{exampleblock}{Example}
  Example block.
\end{exampleblock}
\begin{alertblock}{Alert}
  Warm alert block.
\end{alertblock}
```

Block

Standard Beamer block.

Example

Example block.

Alert

Warm alert block.

Code listings

Frames with listings need the `[fragile]` option. The `minimalist` listings style is already active:

```
def peso_total(envio):
    # Suma el peso de cada línea de suministro
    return sum(l.peso * l.cantidad for l in envio.lineas)
```

Inline: `assert peso_total(e) <= v.capacidad`. Choose another language with `[language=Java]`, or set it for the whole deck with `\lstset{language=Python}`.

Math, definitions and theorems

```
\begin{definition}
  A set $S$ is \emph{finite} if\ldots
\end{definition}
\begin{theorem}
  $\displaystyle\sum_{i=1}^{n} i = \frac{n(n+1)
     }{2}$
\end{theorem}
```

Definition

A set S is *finite* if...

Theorem

$$\sum_{i=1}^{n} i = \frac{n(n+1)}{2}$$

The names (“Definition”, “Teorema”, ...) are translated by `babel`.

Reference

Command reference

Command / environment	Purpose
`twocol[split,gap,align]`, `\nextcol`	Two columns; `\nextcol` starts the second one
`threecol[gap]`, `\nextcol`	Three equal columns (same `\nextcol`)
`onecol[width]`	Centered single column of a given fraction of the width
`callout[opts]`	Outlined box, optional `title=`
`statement[opts]`	Centered, emphasized box
`notebox[opts]`	Tinted note with left bar
`warnbox[opts]`	Warm-colored box for a warning or key attention point
`\concept{}`, `\code{}`, `\arr`	Bold term, monospace, arrow
`\flowline{A,B,C}`	Inline chain A $\rightarrow$ B $\rightarrow$ C
`\flow[opts]{A,B,C}`	TikZ node chain joined by arrows
`mn node`, `mn highlight`, `mn alert node`, `mn arrow`, `mn dashed arrow`, `mn circle`	TikZ styles
`L{w}`, `C{w}`, `R{w}`	Fixed-width table columns
`lstlisting` (style `minimalist`)	Code listings (fragile frames)

Customization

- **Aspect ratio:** `\documentclass[aspectratio=43]{beamer}`.
- **Top alignment:** class option `t`; use `[c]` on a single frame to center it.
- **Palette / accent:** `[palette=teal]` or `[accent=red!60!black]`.
- **Margins:** `\setbeamersize{text margin left=1.2cm}`.
- **Node look:** `\tikzset{mn node/.append style={fill=black!5}}`.
- **Boxes:** `\tcbset{mn base/.append style={arc=3pt}}`.
- **Table spacing:** `\renewcommand{\arraystretch}{1.2}`.

Override these *after* `\usetheme`.

Migrating from the original ad-hoc template

Original		Theme
`\concepto{...}`	→	`\concept{...}`
`\caja{\centering ...}`	→	`statement` or `callout`
`columns` + `\column{0.47\linewidth}`	→	`twocol[split=0.5]` + `\nextcol`
TikZ chain with `every node/.style`	→	`\flow{A, B, C}` or `mn node`
`p{4cm}` with `\raggedright`	→	`L{4cm}`
Preamble with fonts, colors, footline	→	`\usetheme{minimalist}`